

BANTAYLAOT+: AN ENHANCED SYSTEM FOR
OFFLINE AND SECURE MONITORING OF
PHILIPPINE MUNICIPAL FISHERIES WITH
AI INTEGRATION PREPAREDNESS

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The thesis hereto attached entitled BANTAYLAOT+: AN ENHANCED SYSTEM FOR OFFLINE AND SECURE MONITORING OF PHILIPPINE MUNICIPAL FISHERIES WITH AI INTEGRATION PREPAREDNESS, prepared and submitted by MAGENTA T. ALARCON, in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of BACHELOR OF SCIENCE (COMPUTER SCIENCE) is hereby accepted.

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BIOGRAPHICAL SKETCH

MAGENTA T. ALARCON is a candidate for the degree of Bachelor of Science in Computer Science at the University of the Philippines Los Baños.

Born in Las Pinas City, Metro Manila, Her academic interests include software development, web and mobile technologies, and information systems. As part of her undergraduate studies, she worked on the enhancement of BantayLaot+, a mobile and web-based fisheries monitoring system designed to support municipal fisheries management in the Philippines.

She aspires to contribute to the development of technology-driven solutions that address real-world challenges and promote sustainable development.

MAGENTA T. ALARCON

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ABSTRACT

MAGENTA T. ALARCON, University of the Philippines Los Baños, JUNE 2026. **BANTAYLAOT+: AN ENHANCED SYSTEM FOR OFFLINE AND SECURE MONITORING OF PHILIPPINE MUNICIPAL FISHERIES WITH AI INTEGRATION PREPAREDNESS**

Major Professor: PROF. VAL RANDOLF M. MADRID

Municipal fisheries monitoring in the Philippines is constrained by intermittent internet connectivity, manual reporting workflows, and fragmented data infrastructure, limiting the effectiveness of enforcement and research in coastal communities. This paper presents BantayLaot+, an enhanced fisheries monitoring system targeting two municipalities in Misamis Oriental, built on an offline-first mobile architecture that stores session, catch, violation, and GPS data locally using Android’s Room Database and synchronizes records to a multi-tiered backend via WorkManager once network connectivity is available. JWT authentication tokens are persisted in SharedPreferences to maintain session continuity throughout extended field operations without connectivity dependency. The system employs a structured image pipeline—compressing and uploading photographs via Cloudinary—that lays the data foundation for future AI-assisted species identification without requiring changes to the existing schema. Three role-differentiated web dashboards, implemented in React.js and powered by a MERN stack, serve municipal administrators, central administrators, and researchers with jurisdiction-appropriate analytics including CPUE summaries, GPS route visualization via OpenLayers, and anonymized registration and catch statistics. Usability was evaluated using the System Usability Scale (SUS) with fifteen respondents distributed across three user groups. Results indicate that BantayLaot+ addresses the offline reliability, authentication continuity, and structured data collection gaps identified in the predecessor system, and establishes the infrastructure required for future AI model integration.

INTRODUCTION

The Philippines, an archipelagic nation with over 36,000 kilometers of coastline, depends profoundly on its marine resources for economic sustenance, food security, and cultural identity. Fisheries, particularly small-scale and municipal operations, serve as a primary livelihood for millions of coastal households, contributing significantly to national nutrition and local economies (Food and Agriculture Organization [FAO], 2023). However, the sustainability of these resources is increasingly jeopardized by illegal, unreported, and unregulated (IUU) fishing activities. According to the World Wildlife Fund (2022), IUU fishing undermines fish stock recovery, distorts market dynamics, and erodes the ecological integrity of marine habitats, especially in municipal waters where enforcement capacity is often limited.

Efforts to curb IUU fishing have traditionally relied on manual reporting, sporadic patrols, and centralized data systems, which are often inaccessible to remote communities. These limitations have prompted a shift toward digital interventions that promote participatory monitoring and decentralized data collection. Technological innovations, particularly mobile and web-based platforms, offer scalable solutions for enhancing transparency, accountability, and responsiveness in fisheries governance.

In response to these challenges, BantayLaot was developed as a community-oriented digital system designed to assist both government agencies and fisherfolk in reporting fish catch data, tracking vessel movements, and documenting IUU violations Gallero (2025). The system leveraged mobile and web technologies to provide GPS-based session tracking, fish catch documentation, and offline data storage, alongside a web platform for CPUE analysis and geospatial visualization. Initial evaluation confirmed its foundational functionality; however, testing revealed several operational gaps: the absence of an account and authentication system, a single-role web interface with no differentiation between administrator tiers or researchers, lack of structured synchronization state management, and no organized

image pipeline for future analytical use. These shortcomings are particularly relevant in geographically isolated coastal areas, where extended offline operation and multi-stakeholder data access are operational requirements.

To address these gaps, this study proposes BantayLaot+, an enhanced version of the original system. BantayLaot+ introduces JWT-based authentication with locally persisted tokens for offline session continuity, a structured WorkManager synchronization pipeline with per-record state tracking, a multi-tiered server architecture separating per-municipality and central data stores, role-differentiated web dashboards for municipal administrators, central administrators, and researchers, and a structured image collection pipeline designed to support future AI-assisted species identification. By aligning architectural design with the operational realities of coastal communities, BantayLaot+ aspires to strengthen fisheries monitoring and support sustainable resource management.

Statement of the Problem

The existing BantayLaot system lacks an account and authentication system, role-based access control, structured synchronization state management, and a multi-tiered data architecture, limiting its suitability for multi-stakeholder operational use. There is a need for an enhanced, securely designed system with a structured image pipeline that lays the groundwork for future AI integration, to enable more reliable and scalable fisheries monitoring.

Objectives of the Study

This study aims to enhance the existing BantayLaot system by improving its mobile application, web application, and database/backend infrastructure to support more efficient, secure, and scalable field operations. Specifically, the study seeks to:

1. Enhance the mobile application with improved usability, JWT-based authentication, structured offline data storage with per-record synchronization state tracking, and

a structured image collection pipeline designed to support future AI-assisted fish species identification, while retaining manual species and weight input.

2. Develop a secure multi-tiered database with per-municipality local storage and a central cloud instance, along with role-differentiated web dashboards for municipal administrators, central administrators, and researchers, with a data schema designed to accommodate future AI integration without structural changes.
3. Test and deploy the enhanced system in real-world monitoring environments to evaluate performance, usability, system reliability, and suitability for operational use.

Significance of the Study

BantayLaot+ serves three primary stakeholder groups. Fisherfolk gain a more reliable field tool with offline catch and violation reporting, continuous GPS tracking, and an interface designed for varying digital literacy levels. Municipal and central government agencies benefit from structured, role-based access to catch logs, violation records, and CPUE analytics, supporting evidence-based enforcement. Researchers access anonymized aggregated datasets through a dedicated dashboard, enabling fisheries trend analysis and conservation research without exposing fisher identities. Collectively, these contributions support Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 14: *Life Below Water* through improved marine resource monitoring and conservation, and SDG 11: *Sustainable Cities and Communities* by strengthening data-driven coastal governance and sustainable local livelihood management.

Scope and Limitations

This study covers the development and evaluation of BantayLaot+, targeting two municipalities in Misamis Oriental for future deployment. The mobile application (Android/Kotlin) supports offline catch and violation reporting, continuous GPS tracking, and background

data synchronization to locally hosted municipal servers. The web platform (React.js) provides dashboards for municipal administrators, central administrators, and researchers, with analytics including CPUE analysis, violation summaries, and GPS session visualization using OpenLayers.

A multi-tiered database architecture is used: per-municipality MongoDB instances running on local servers (localhost) at each municipality, and a central cloud MongoDB database deployed on Railway. Images are stored via Cloudinary. All species, gear, and weight inputs are entered manually; image data collected during deployment provides the foundation for future AI model training.

Limitations include image quality variability affecting future AI model training, device hardware differences affecting GPS precision, small respondent pool (15 total across three user groups), and time constraints limiting evaluation under extreme connectivity conditions.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

BantayLaot: The Predecessor System

BantayLaot, developed by Gallero Gallero (2025), established the foundational concept of a mobile-assisted fisheries monitoring platform for Philippine municipal waters. The system enabled fisherfolk to document catch records, submit IUU violation reports, and log GPS-tracked fishing sessions via a Kotlin mobile application, with offline storage through Room Database and synchronization to a MERN stack backend. Its single web dashboard provided CPUE analysis, geospatial route visualization using OpenLayers, and violation summaries for administrative review. The system was evaluated through laboratory testing using simulated data, and this evaluation surfaced the operational constraints—absence of an account and authentication system, a single undifferentiated administrative role, lack of structured sync state management, and no organized image pipeline—that BantayLaot+ directly addresses. This work builds upon and extends that foundation.

Offline-First Architecture and Session Persistence

Field-based systems in low-connectivity environments require offline-first designs that store data locally and synchronize when network access is restored Serrano et al. (2020). BantayLaot+ implements this using Android's Room Database for local SQLite storage of fishing sessions, catches, violation reports, and GPS tracks. Session continuity is maintained through JWT tokens stored in SharedPreferences, enabling continued app access without repeated server authentication. Dahiru and Ibrahim (2021) validate this approach for secure mobile systems operating under intermittent connectivity Dahiru and Ibrahim (2021).

Background Synchronization

WorkManager is the recommended Android framework for deferred, constraint-aware background tasks Google Developers (2022). BantayLaot+ uses it to automatically upload catch logs, GPS tracks, violation reports, and images to municipal servers once network connectivity is available. Timestamp-based conflict resolution, as recommended by Kumar and Singh (2020), ensures consistency across records submitted from different devices Kumar and Singh (2020). Goncalves et al. (2020) confirm that background synchronization significantly reduces data loss in field-deployed mobile applications with variable connectivity Goncalves, Ferreira, and Kostakos (2020).

MERN Stack and Multi-Role Web Dashboards

The MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js) supports scalable, real-time data platforms Chodorow (2013). BantayLaot+ uses this stack to deliver three role-differentiated dashboards: municipal administrators manage jurisdiction-level catch and violation data; central administrators access aggregated cross-municipality analytics; researchers view anonymized datasets for analysis. API-driven architectures support secure, multi-role data access across independent municipality servers Alzubaidi (2020).

Geospatial Visualization

OpenLayers, paired with OpenStreetMap tiles, provides a lightweight and extensible web mapping solution suitable for tracking and spatial analysis Haklay and Weber (2008). BantayLaot+ uses OpenLayers to render GPS session routes and violation incident locations on the web dashboard, enabling both operational review and geographic pattern detection.

Image-Based Documentation and AI Preparedness

Structured image capture and organized storage are foundational for future machine learning applications in species identification Norouzzadeh et al. (2018). BantayLaot+ captures images for fish catches, vessel documentation, and violation evidence, storing them via Cloudinary with metadata linking to sessions and users. This repository supports future AI model training while all current inputs remain manual.

METHODOLOGY

This study followed an iterative, feature-driven development approach aligned with agile principles. Development was organized into sequential sprints, each targeting a discrete system component: the offline-first mobile architecture, background synchronization, JWT-based authentication, the mobile View Binding interface, per-municipality and central REST APIs, and the role-differentiated web dashboards. Each sprint concluded with integration testing before the next phase was initiated, allowing defects and architectural inconsistencies to be identified and resolved incrementally. The evaluation phase applied the System Usability Scale (SUS) to representative respondents from three user groups following system development and testing targeting two municipalities in Misamis Oriental.

Technology Specifications

Development was conducted on machines running Windows 11 with Intel Core i5 processors and 16 GB RAM. This configuration was sufficient for running the Android emulator, local Node.js server instances, and MongoDB simultaneously during development and integration testing.

Development Tools

The technology stack was selected to meet the system's requirements for offline operation, multi-role access, and geospatial visualization. Visual Studio Code served as the primary editor for backend and web development. Android Studio was used for mobile development, compilation, and device emulation. The mobile application was written in Kotlin using traditional Android Views with View Binding for layout construction, enabling direct access to UI elements while maintaining clear separation of layout and logic.

The backend and web interface were built on the MERN stack. MongoDB provides

document-oriented storage suited to the variable structure of catch records, violation reports, and GPS tracks. Express.js serves as the REST API framework across both the municipal and central server instances. React.js powers the web dashboards, and Node.js handles server-side processing and synchronization logic. OpenLayers paired with OpenStreetMap tiles provides the map rendering layer for GPS session routes and violation incident locations. On mobile, Android Location Services handles continuous GPS acquisition, and WorkManager governs deferred background synchronization subject to network connectivity constraints. Room Database manages local SQLite storage on the device, and SharedPreferences provides secure JWT token persistence for offline authentication continuity. Cloudinary, integrated via Multer middleware, handles image upload and cloud storage.

System Architecture

BantayLaot+ employs a multi-tiered architecture comprising five functional layers: client, API, processing, data, and external services, as illustrated in Fig. 1.

The *client layer* consists of the Android mobile application (Kotlin) and the React.js web application. The mobile app communicates with the municipal REST APIs via HTTPS/REST for offline-aware data submission (POST/GET), with all records written locally first and transmitted once connectivity is available. The web application communicates with the cloud REST API via HTTPS/REST for cross-municipality analytics and user management.

The *API layer* comprises two municipal REST API servers deployed on local machines at each municipality and a central cloud REST API. The municipal APIs handle authentication, CRUD operations for catch logs, violation reports, and GPS tracks, and receive batched uploads from mobile clients during synchronization. Synchronized records are forwarded to the cloud REST API via a sync queue, and configuration parameters are pulled back from the cloud server to keep municipal instances consistent.

The *processing layer* contains three server components and a dedicated authentication service. Municipal Server #1 and Municipal Server #2 handle jurisdiction-scoped data

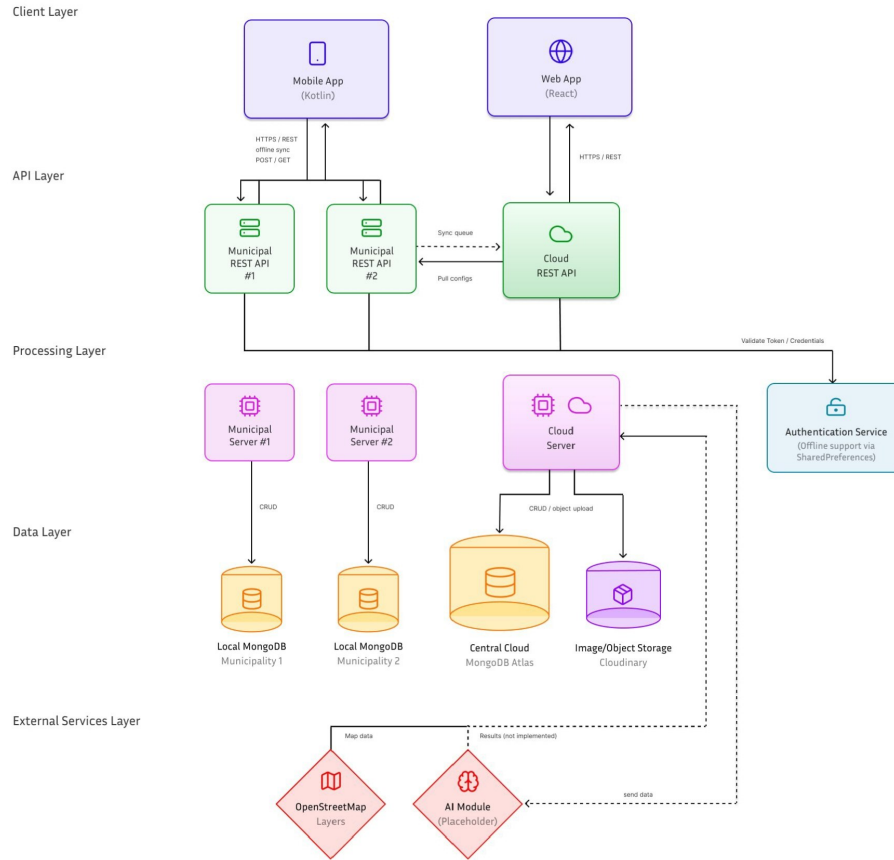


Figure 1. BantayLaot+ Multi-Tiered System Architecture

processing for their respective municipalities, while the Cloud Server manages cross-municipality data aggregation. The Authentication Service validates tokens and credentials for all incoming requests and provides offline authentication support through `SharedPreferences` on the mobile client, allowing the app to remain accessible without a live server connection during extended field operations. `WorkManager` governs synchronization scheduling on the mobile side, queuing uploads subject to network availability and retrying failed transfers automatically. Timestamp-based conflict resolution at the cloud server ensures consistency when records from different devices overlap.

The *data layer* consists of per-municipality local MongoDB instances for jurisdiction-scoped operational data and a central MongoDB Atlas instance in the cloud for aggregated analytics and researcher access. Fish, vessel, and violation images are stored in Cloudinary (Image/Object

Storage), with metadata linking each asset to its associated session, user, and record.

The *external services layer* encompasses OpenStreetMap, which supplies map tile data for GPS route visualization in the web dashboards via OpenLayers, and an AI Module placeholder that represents the intended future integration point for AI-assisted species identification. The AI Module is not implemented in the current version; the data pipeline and schema are structured to accommodate it without requiring architectural changes when the module is developed.

Use Case Scenarios

Mobile Application Use Case

The mobile workflow is structured around four operational stages corresponding to a typical fishing trip, as depicted in Figs. 2–5.

Pre-Departure. As shown in Fig. 2, the fisherfolk authenticates using locally persisted JWT credentials, eliminating dependency on server availability at login time. Upon successful authentication, the user initiates a new fishing session. GPS tracking is initialized via Android Location Services, and Room Database prepares local storage partitions for the session, catch, violation, and GPS track records associated with that trip.

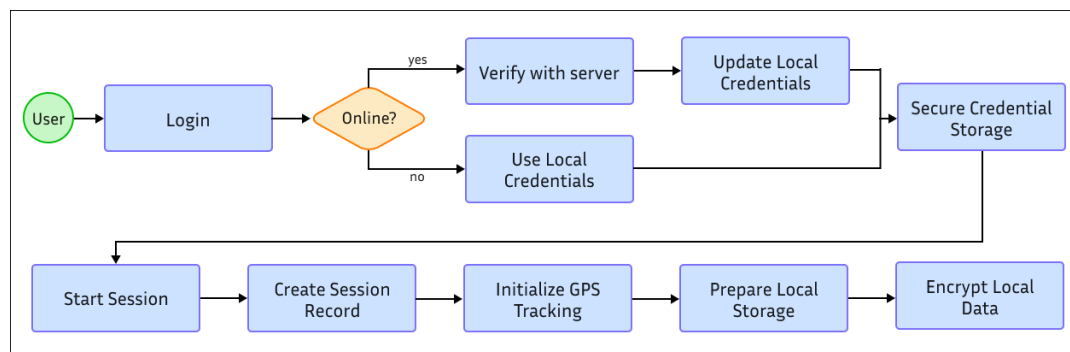


Figure 2. Pre-departure stage use case flow

At Sea. Fig. 3 illustrates the at-sea stage, during which GPS coordinates are recorded every 30 seconds and written to Room Database regardless of connectivity state. Fisherfolk may submit violation reports at any point by capturing a geotagged photo and manually entering the violating vessel description, gear type, and incident narrative. Violation coordinates are automatically attached from the current GPS fix, and all records are stored locally with PENDING synchronization status.

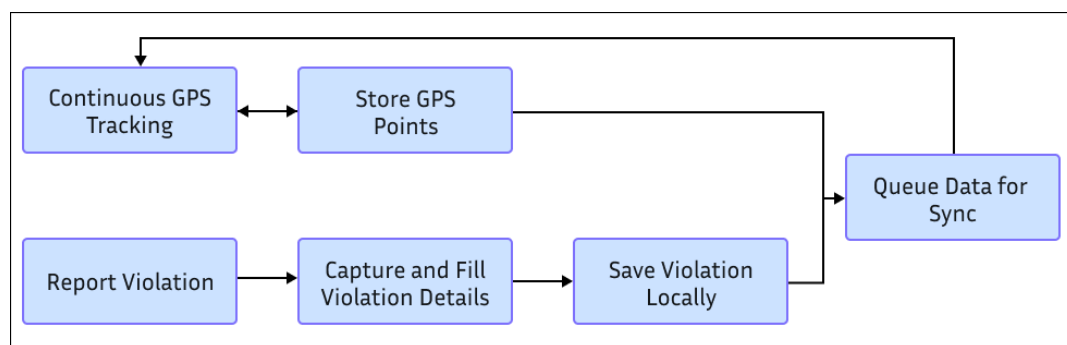


Figure 3. At-sea stage use case flow

Returning to Shore. As depicted in Fig. 4, upon returning to shore, fisherfolk document catches by photographing each haul and manually selecting the species from an autocomplete dropdown of 975 recognized Philippine species, entering weight in kilograms, and selecting one of three gear categories: Surface Gill Net, Bottom Set Gill Net, or Hook and Line. Completed catch records are appended to the session and marked PENDING.

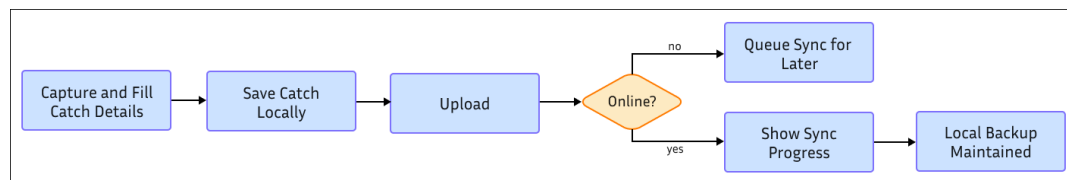


Figure 4. Returning-to-shore stage use case flow

Synchronization. Fig. 5 shows the synchronization stage. WorkManager evaluates network and battery constraints and initiates batch upload when conditions are met. Sessions,

catches, violations, GPS tracks, and compressed images (scaled to a maximum dimension of 1024 px at 70% JPEG quality) are transmitted to the municipal REST API. Per-record sync status transitions from PENDING to SYNCED on successful upload or FAILED on error, with automatic retry scheduled for failed records. The central server subsequently applies timestamp-based conflict resolution before persisting records to the aggregated database.

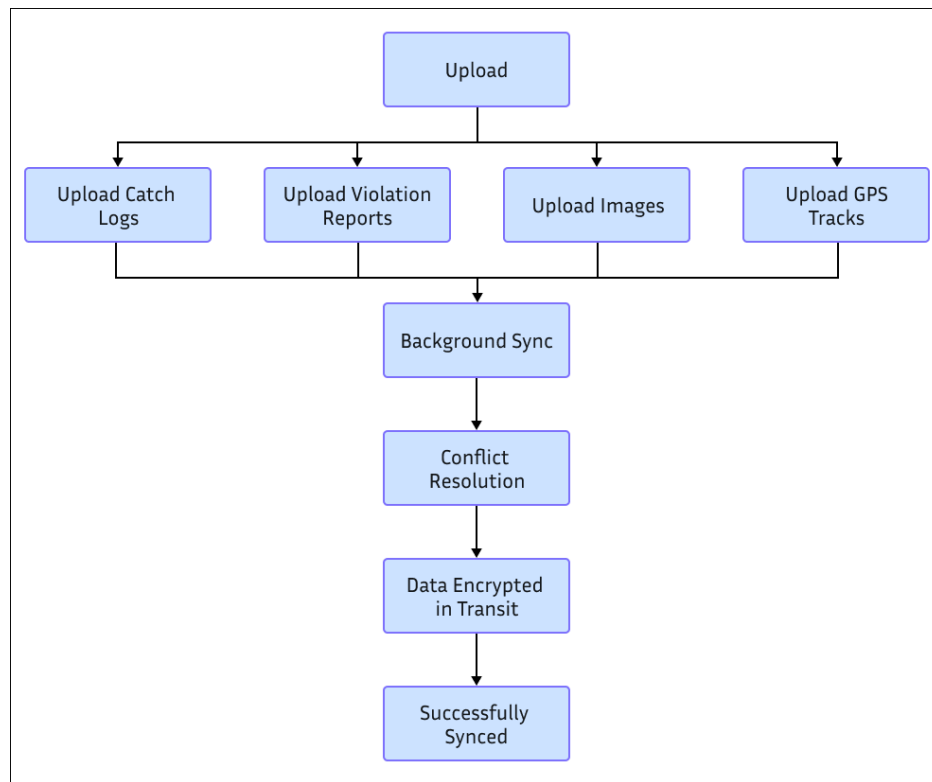


Figure 5. Synchronization stage use case flow

Web Application Use Case

The web platform provides three role-differentiated access tiers enforced by JWT middleware with role-based routing at the API level. The workflows for each role are illustrated in Figs. 6–8.

Municipal Administrator (Fig. 6). Approves or declines fisher registration requests;

creates fisher accounts directly; manages user accounts with municipality assignments; reviews catch logs and violation reports filtered by date and barangay; views GPS session routes on OpenLayers maps.

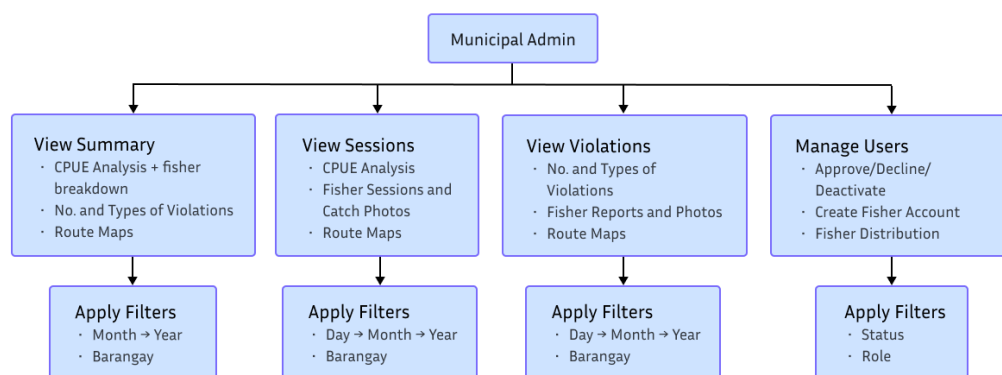


Figure 6. Web Application — Municipal Administrator Workflow

Central Administrator (Fig. 7). Accesses aggregated cross-municipality data including CPUE trends, violation pattern summaries, and session volume statistics. Creates researcher and municipal administrator accounts from the Manage Users page.

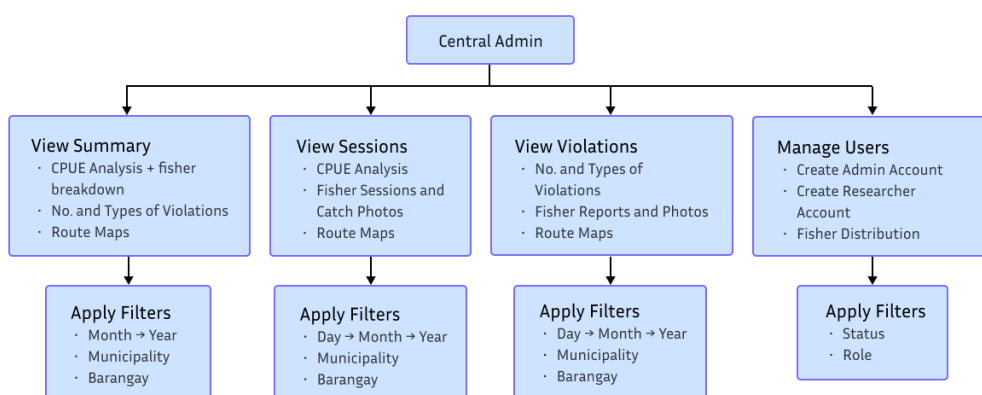


Figure 7. Web Application — Central Administrator Workflow

Researcher (Fig. 8). Views anonymized catch and violation datasets with filtering by date, municipality, and barangay. Accesses CPUE aggregates, species distribution data, and

fisher registration statistics for conservation trend analysis without exposure to individual fisher identities. Downloads CSV and image exports from all four dashboard tabs.

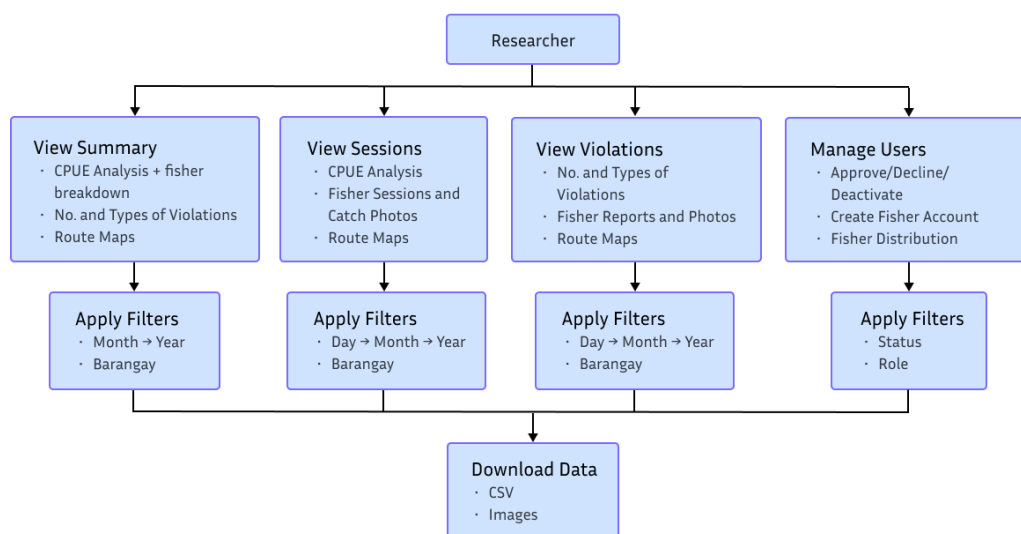


Figure 8. Web Application — Researcher Workflow

Evaluation: System Usability Scale (SUS)

Usability evaluation was conducted using the System Usability Scale (SUS), a validated 10-item questionnaire producing scores on a 0–100 scale. Scores above 68 are considered above average; scores above 80.3 are rated excellent Bangor, Kortum, and Miller (2008). Evaluation was conducted separately for three system components—the mobile application, the municipal administrator dashboard, and the researcher dashboard—with five respondents assigned to each (15 total). Respondents were general users tasked with completing representative workflows on their assigned platform. No domain background in fisheries was required, reflecting the system’s design goal of accessibility across varying digital literacy levels. SUS items were rated immediately following guided task interaction sessions.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The development of BantayLaot+ produced a functional, multi-component fisheries monitoring system consisting of an Android mobile application, two municipality-level REST API servers, a central cloud-hosted aggregation server, and a role-differentiated web platform, intended for deployment across two municipalities in Misamis Oriental. All primary objectives stated in the study were achieved: the mobile application supports offline-first operation with background synchronization; and the web platform delivers structured multi-role data access. The structured image pipeline established during development provides the dataset infrastructure required for future AI model training once field deployment is initiated.

Mobile Application

The mobile application was implemented in Kotlin using traditional Android Views with View Binding and tested on Android devices during development. The interface is organized around a session-based workflow guiding fisherfolk sequentially through pre-departure preparation, at-sea operations, catch documentation, and synchronization. The following subsections present the key interface views produced during development.

Authentication and Session Initialization

Upon launching the application, fisherfolk authenticate using credentials issued by the municipal administrator, as shown in Fig. 9. JWT tokens received upon successful login are persisted in SharedPreferences, allowing the application to remain accessible offline without requiring repeated server authentication for subsequent sessions. Upon authentication, the user is directed to the home dashboard (Fig. 9), which presents the current session status and provides access to all primary functions: starting a new fishing

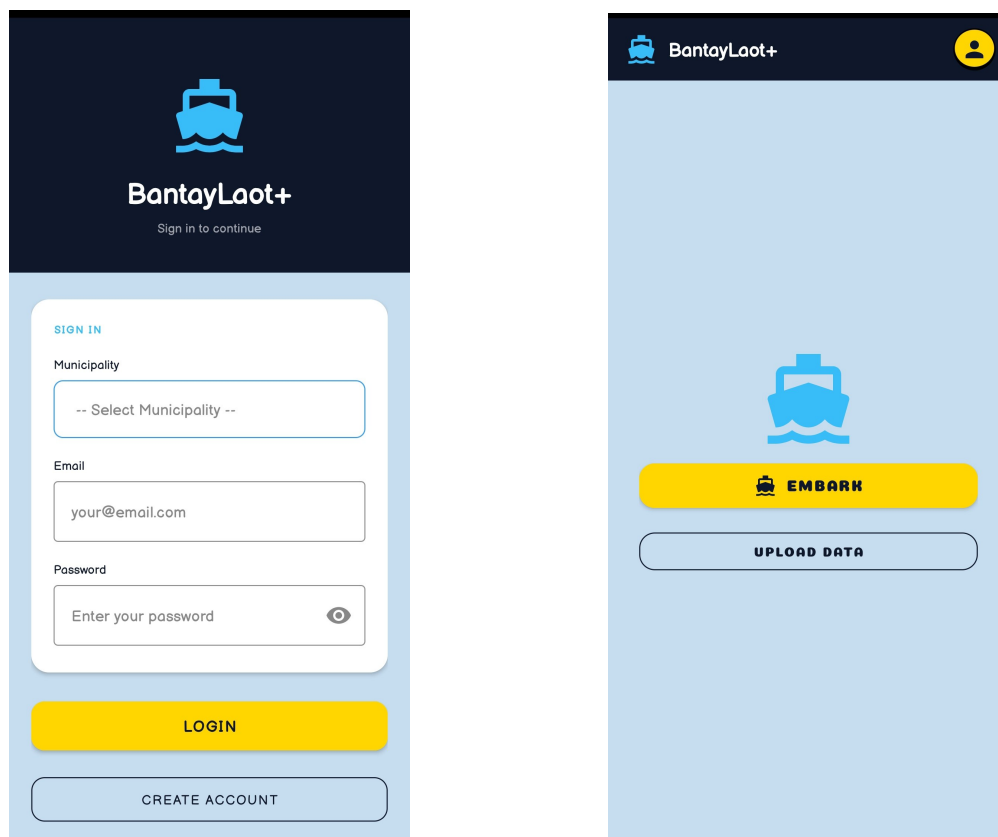


Figure 9. Mobile Application — Login Screen (left) and Home Dashboard (right).

session, reporting violations, documenting catches, and uploading data to the server.

Pre-Departure and GPS Initialization

As illustrated in Fig. 10, when initiating a session, the application verifies location permissions and begins recording GPS coordinates via Android Location Services. An active session indicator confirms that GPS tracking is running in the background. All session metadata—start timestamp, fisher identifier, and municipality assignment—is written to Room Database immediately upon session creation, decoupled from server availability.

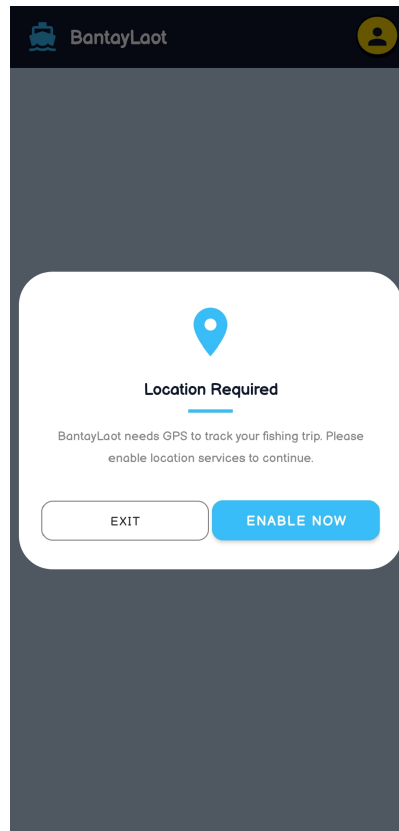


Figure 10. Mobile Application — Pre-Departure Session Start

At-Sea Operations and Violation Reporting

Fig. 11 shows the active session view displayed during at-sea operations. GPS fixes are recorded every 30 seconds to Room Database regardless of network state. When a violation is observed, the fisherfolk accesses the violation reporting form shown in Fig. 11, which allows capture of a geotagged photograph and manual entry of the violating vessel description, gear type, and narrative notes. Geographic coordinates at the time of submission are automatically attached to the violation record, and the report is stored locally with PENDING status and queued for upload.

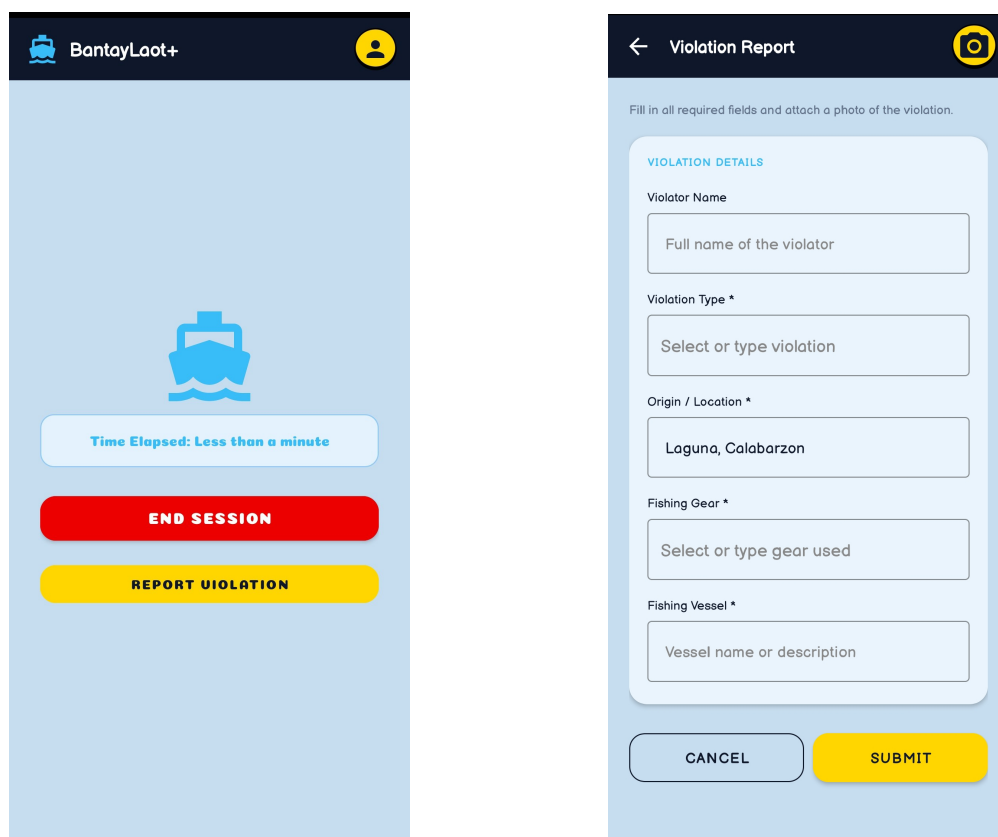
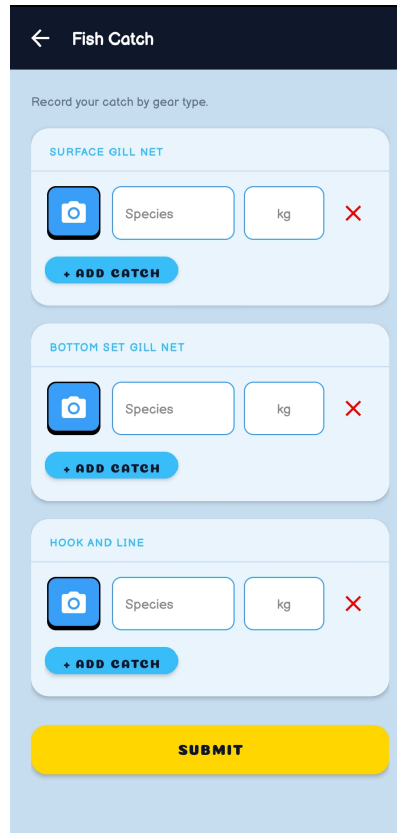


Figure 11. Mobile Application — At Sea (left) and Violation Report (right).

Catch Documentation

Catch documentation is initiated upon returning to shore. As shown in Fig. 12, the fisherfolk captures a photograph of each haul and then enters catch details manually. The species and weight entry form allows the fisherfolk to select a species from an autocomplete dropdown of 975 recognized Philippine species, enter weight in kilograms, and select one of three gear categories: Surface Gill Net, Bottom Set Gill Net, or Hook and Line. The underlying data model is structured so that a future AI classification backend can be integrated without schema changes.



The screenshot shows a mobile application interface titled "Fish Catch". At the top, there is a dark blue header with a back arrow and the title. Below the header, a light blue instruction text reads "Record your catch by gear type." The main content area is divided into three sections, each representing a different gear type: "SURFACE GILL NET", "BOTTOM SET GILL NET", and "HOOK AND LINE". Each section contains a camera icon, a "Species" input field, a "kg" input field, a red "X" icon, and a blue "+ ADD CATCH" button. At the bottom of the screen, there is a large yellow "SUBMIT" button.

Figure 12. Mobile Application — Catch Documentation

Upload and Synchronization

Synchronization is initiated from the home screen via a visible Upload button, which is accessible when no session is active. Tapping the button reinitializes the Retrofit client with the latest stored token and enqueues a one-time WorkManager task constrained to any active network connection. The home screen observes the WorkManager status and provides inline toast feedback: a queued state when awaiting connectivity, a running state during active upload, and success or failure states upon completion. Failed uploads are automatically retried by the periodic WorkManager task, which runs approximately every hour. Per-entity sync states (PENDING, SYNCED, FAILED) are tracked in Room Database for sessions, catches, violations, and GPS tracks, ensuring no record is retransmitted unnecessarily.

Web Application

The web application was developed using React.js. Three distinct dashboard views were implemented for municipal administrators, central administrators, and researchers, each enforced by JWT middleware with role-based routing at the API level.

Municipal Administrator Dashboard

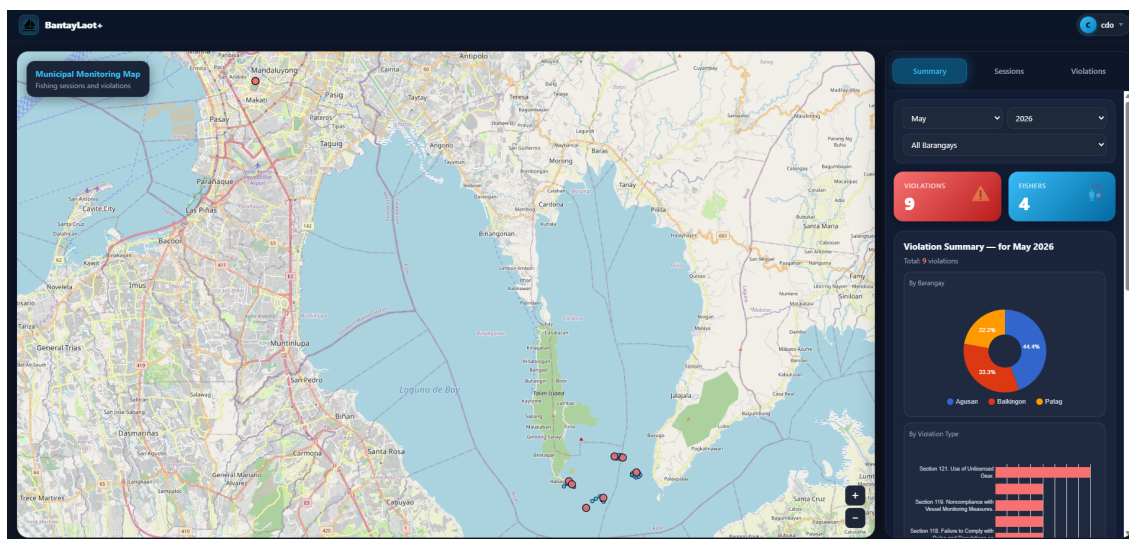


Figure 13. Web Application — Municipal Administrator Summary Tab

The municipal administrator dashboard, shown in Fig. 13, provides jurisdiction-level operational oversight through three tabs. The Summary Tab offers month, year, and barangay filters and displays two stat cards—total violations and active fishers for the selected period. Below the stat cards, a Violation Summary card presents a Google Charts pie chart of violations by barangay and a bar chart grouped by violation type. A CPUE card follows, showing a fish species catch pie chart, a per-gear CPUE row expressing catch in kilograms per hour, and an expandable fisher breakdown with session counts per fisher.

The Sessions Tab, illustrated in Fig. 14, is filtered by a single date input and an optional barangay selector. It opens with a daily fish catch pie chart and a CPUE summary

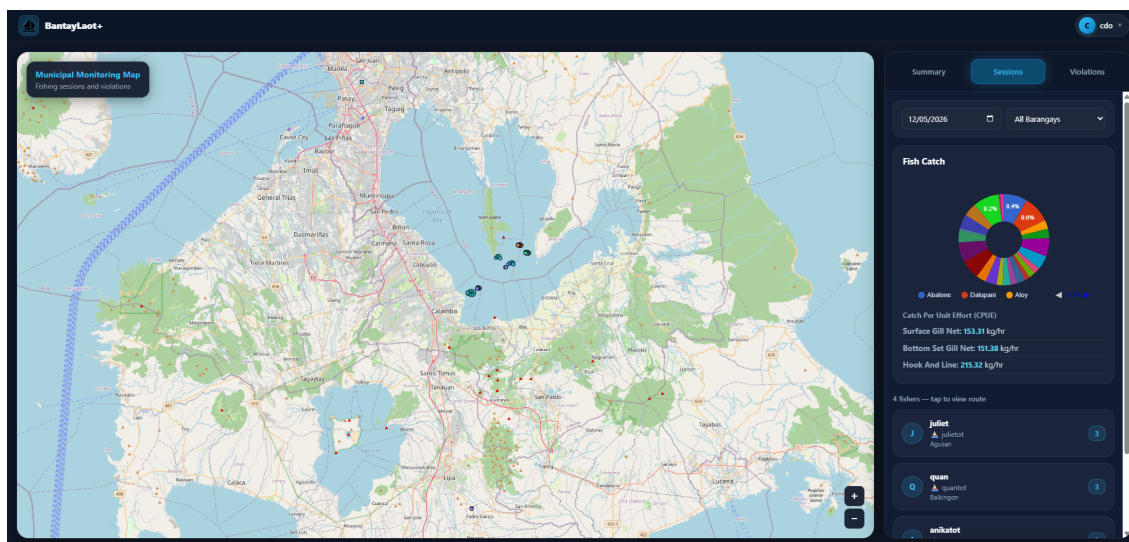


Figure 14. Web Application — Sessions Tab with Expanded Fisher Detail (Municipal View)

row, followed by a list of fisher cards each bearing a session count badge. Selecting a fisher card expands a detail view containing the session's start and end timestamps, a catch analysis pie chart, per-gear CPUE values, and catch photographs retrieved from Cloudinary. The GPS route recorded during that session is rendered as an OpenLayers polyline on the map shown in Fig. 16, providing a spatial record of the vessel's path within the municipality.

The Violations Tab (Fig. 15) shares the same date and barangay filters. A bar chart of violations by type appears at the top with a running total, followed by reporter cards. Expanding a card reveals the violation photograph, the violator's identity, the specific violation type, the fishing gear and vessel involved, the reported origin area, and the submission timestamp.

User registration management is handled through a separate Manage Users page (Fig. 17). The page presents a sortable table of all accounts registered within the municipality, with role badges distinguishing Fishers, Municipal Admins, and Researchers, and status badges indicating whether each account is Approved, Pending, Declined, or Deactivated. Municipal administrators review incoming registration requests and approve, decline, or

deactivate accounts directly from this interface. They may also bypass the self-registration flow entirely by using the Add Fisher form, which creates a fisher account pre-approved with full boat and location details supplied at creation time.

The central administrator dashboard, depicted in Fig. 18, aggregates data from both municipal MongoDB instances via the Railway-hosted central API and follows the same three-tab layout as the municipal dashboard, extended by a municipality selector at the filter level. In the Summary Tab, selecting a municipality causes the violation section to render two side-by-side pie charts—one grouping violations across all municipalities and one breaking them down by barangay within the selected municipality—alongside the violation type bar chart. The CPUE card retains the same species pie chart and expandable fisher breakdown, with each fisher card now labelled by both barangay and municipality of origin.

The Sessions Tab (Fig. 19) presents the same session browsing experience as the

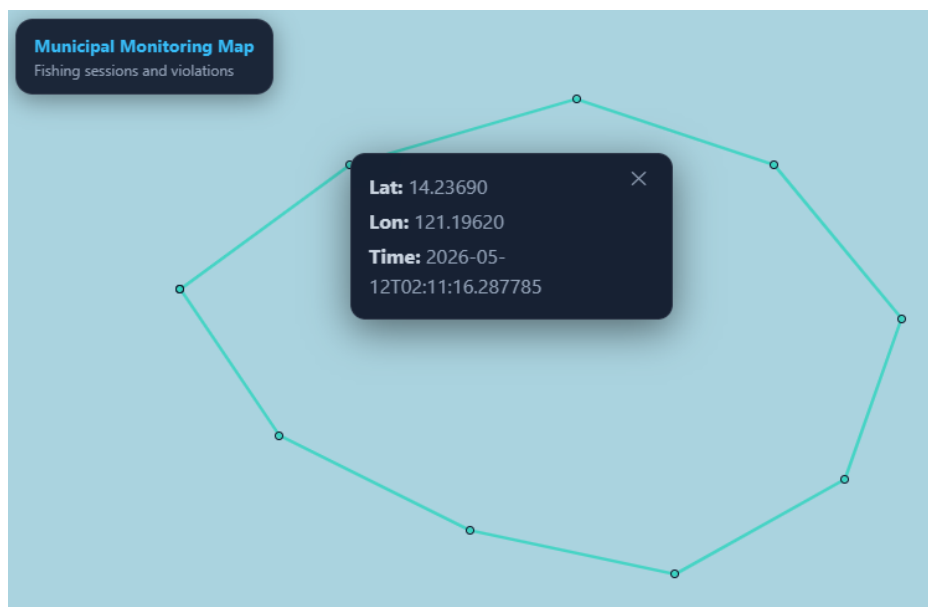


Figure 16. Web Application — GPS Session Route Rendered as OpenLayers Polyline (Municipal View)

municipal view—date, municipality, and barangay filters; a daily fish catch overview; fisher cards with session counts; and expandable session detail with catch analysis and GPS route map—extended to cover all municipalities. The Violations Tab mirrors this structure, giving central administrators a cross-municipality view of violation records with the same date, municipality, and barangay filtering and card expansion available in the municipal dashboard.

Account provisioning is also managed from the Manage Users page, which in the central administrator context allows creation of researcher accounts and municipal administrator accounts directly, without requiring self-registration. The user table in this view spans all municipalities and includes a municipality column, giving central administrators a complete roster of registered users across the deployment.

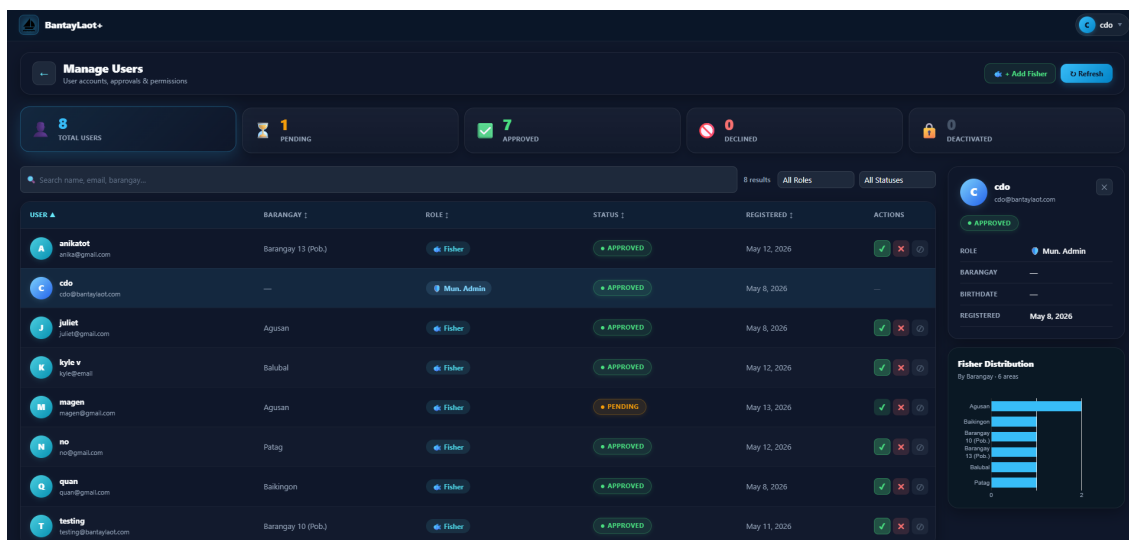


Figure 17. Web Application — Manage Users Page (Municipal View)

Researcher Dashboard

The researcher dashboard presents anonymized fisheries data across four tabs: Summary, Sessions, Violations, and Fishers. As shown in Fig. 20, the Summary Tab replicates the central administrator layout—month, year, municipality, and barangay filters; violation pie charts; violation type bar chart; species catch pie chart; and per-gear CPUE row—but adds a Download CSV button to both the Violation Summary card and the CPUE card, enabling export of the displayed monthly aggregates. No fisher names or identifying details appear anywhere in the researcher view. The Sessions and Violations tabs follow the same pattern as the central equivalents, each with Download CSV and Download Images buttons and individual image download controls within detail views. Violation records expose gear type, vessel description, origin area, GPS coordinates, and timestamp, but omit reporter and violator identities.

The Fishers Tab (Fig. 21), unique to the researcher role, provides aggregate fisher registration statistics. Three stat cards at the top display counts of total registered fishers, approved accounts, and pending accounts. Below, a sortable table groups registrations by municipality; selecting a municipality from the filter switches the table to a barangay-level

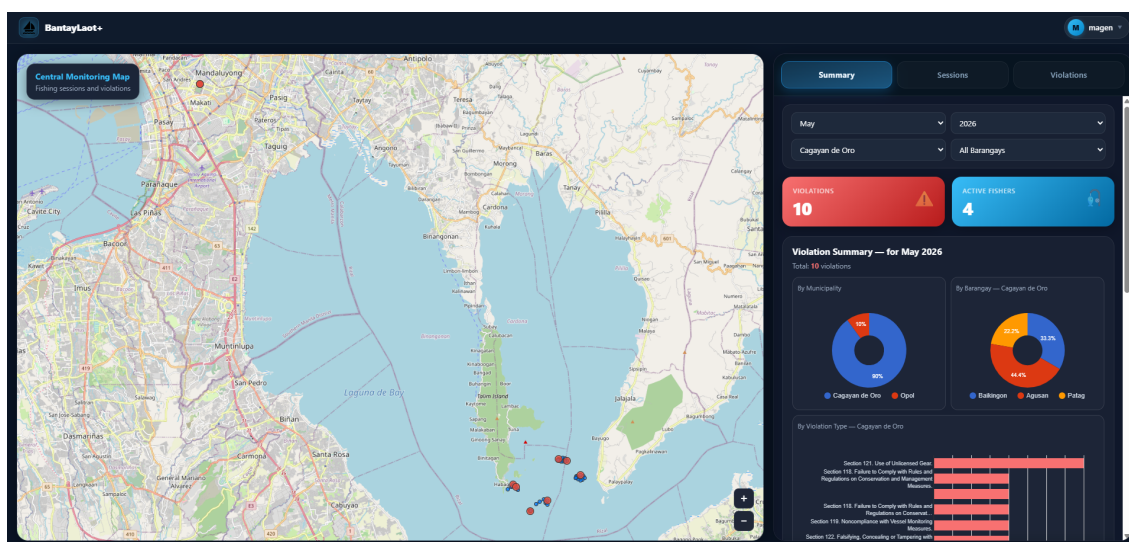


Figure 18. Web Application — Central Administrator Summary Tab

breakdown within that municipality, with Total, Approved, and Pending columns. A Google Charts bar chart renders the same distribution visually, and a Download CSV button exports the displayed counts. A note within the tab confirms that personal identities and sensitive information are excluded from this view.

Technical Difficulties

Development of BantayLaot+ encountered several technical challenges arising from the system's offline-first requirements, multi-tier data architecture, and cross-origin deployment configuration. These are documented as they directly informed design decisions described in the methodology.

Room Database Schema Design for Sync State Management

Managing three distinct synchronization states (PENDING, SYNCED, FAILED) across multiple entity types—sessions, catches, violations, and GPS tracks—required careful schema iteration. Early designs used a single global sync flag per record, which proved insufficient

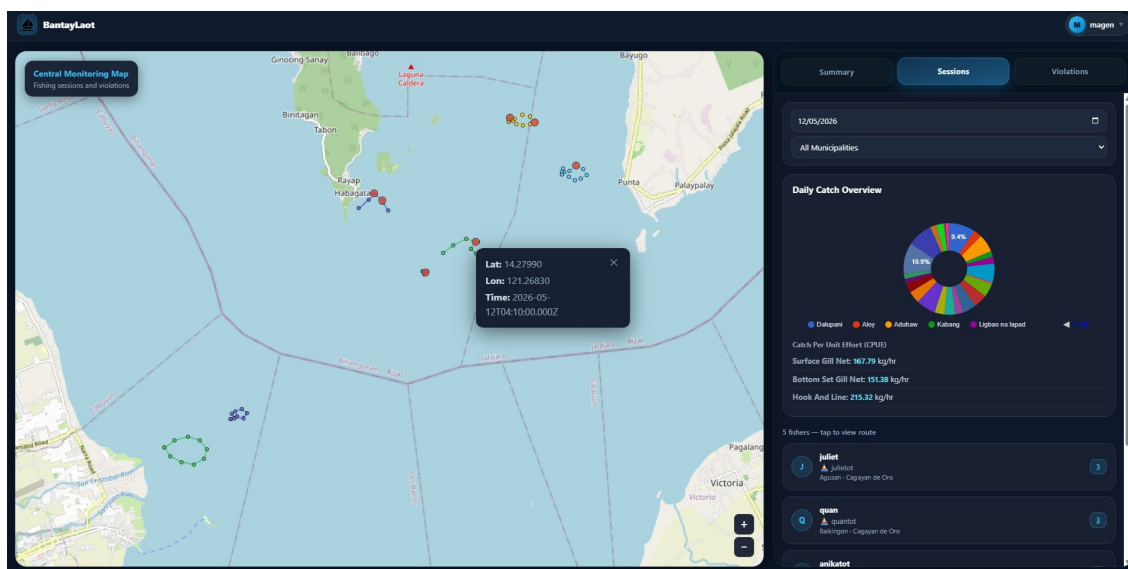


Figure 19. Web Application — Sessions Tab with Cross-Municipality Fisher Cards (Central View)

for partial-upload scenarios where metadata was successfully transmitted but the associated image failed due to payload constraints. The schema was revised to track image URI sync status independently from record metadata, allowing the system to resume interrupted uploads without retransmitting already-synced fields or duplicating data.

WorkManager Constraint Configuration

Configuring WorkManager to queue synchronization reliably while avoiding spurious retries required careful coordination of constraint and work policies. All sync tasks—sessions, catches, violations, GPS tracks, and images—use a single `NetworkType.CONNECTED` constraint, meaning uploads are queued but held until any network connection is available. The one-time upload worker triggered by the Upload button uses `ExistingWorkPolicy.REPLACE`, ensuring that tapping the button while a sync is already running restarts the operation with the latest stored credentials. The periodic background worker uses `ExistingPeriodicWorkPolicy.KEEP` to prevent duplicate background tasks from accumulating across app restarts.

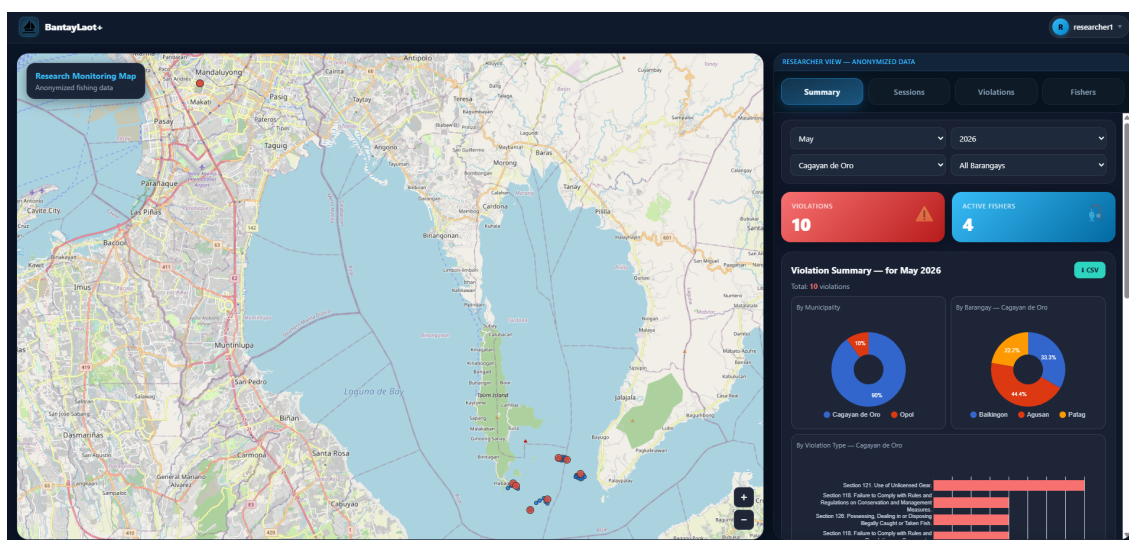


Figure 20. Web Application — Researcher Summary Tab

JWT Token Persistence and Offline Session Continuity

Maintaining authenticated sessions during extended field operations required ensuring that JWT tokens persisted in SharedPreferences remained available for offline use. Fishing trips in the target Misamis Oriental municipalities could exceed 12 hours without cellular access. Because the application reads the stored token from SharedPreferences for every API request and does not require a live server check to load the home screen, users remain logged in and can record sessions, catches, violations, and GPS tracks without connectivity. The token is sent to the server only during the actual upload, at which point a valid network connection is already required by the WorkManager constraint.

GPS Data Volume and Battery Optimization

Recording GPS fixes at 30-second intervals across multi-hour sessions generated substantial data volumes; a single 10-hour trip produces approximately 1,200 GPS records. To reduce battery consumption during extended trips, GPS acquisition was implemented as a foreground service (GPSLocationService) rather than continuous foreground polling,

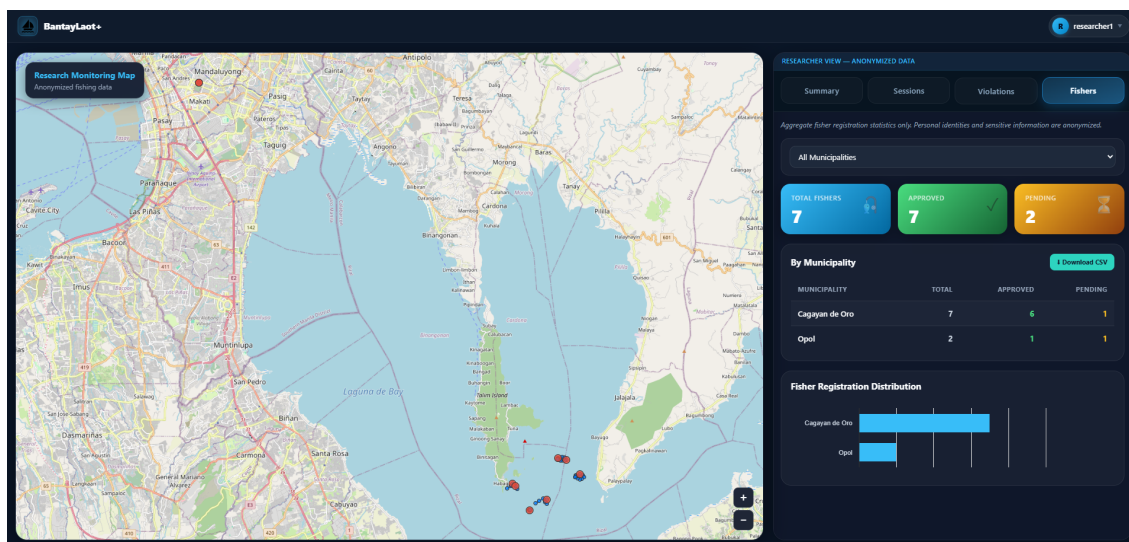


Figure 21. Web Application — Researcher Fishers Tab

with the location client receiving updates from the Fused Location Provider at the configured interval. This approach allows the operating system to manage location hardware duty cycling while the service remains active, measurably reducing battery consumption during extended trips.

Image Compression and Upload Pipeline

Violation and catch photographs captured at full device resolution produced files ranging from 3–8 MB per image, making direct upload impractical over intermittent connections. An image compression pipeline was implemented using Android's Bitmap API within the SyncWorker to scale captures to a maximum dimension of 1024 px at 70% JPEG quality before base64 encoding and transmission. This significantly reduces payload size relative to raw device captures, enabling reliable transfer under limited bandwidth while preserving sufficient detail for the evidence photographs visible in Fig. 15 and for future AI model training.

CORS Configuration for Multi-Origin API Communication

The web application communicates with both the Railway-hosted central API and the localhost municipal APIs, which present different origins to the browser. CORS policies on the Express.js servers initially rejected cross-origin requests from the web client's domain. Each municipal server's CORS configuration was updated to allow all origins, enabling the cross-origin data access required across all three web dashboard views (Figs. 13, 18, and 20). The Railway central API was updated equivalently.

MongoDB Deduplication During Sync

When mobile clients submitted records to the municipal server, duplicate entries could arise if the upload was retried after a partial success. Each record carries a `localId` field assigned at creation time in Room Database. The municipal server uses MongoDB upsert operations keyed on `localId`, ensuring that resubmitting an already-synced record updates the existing document rather than creating a duplicate. The central aggregation server applies the same upsert strategy when receiving bulk data from municipal servers, maintaining idempotent ingestion across the full synchronization pipeline.

Web Application to Localhost Municipal API Communication

A significant architectural limitation emerged during deployment: the React web application cannot directly reach the municipal localhost APIs when accessed from outside the local network, as localhost resolves to the client browser's own machine rather than the municipal server. This was addressed by configuring the municipal APIs to bind to the local area network (LAN) IP address of the on-site machine, making the endpoints reachable to devices on the same network. This constraint directly affects the municipal dashboard views shown in Figs. 13–17, which depend on the municipal API for jurisdiction-specific data. A reverse proxy configuration was documented for future implementation. This

limitation is acknowledged as a deployment constraint in the current version and is listed in the recommendations as a candidate for replacement with cloud-hosted municipal servers.

System Usability Evaluation Results

Usability evaluation was conducted with fifteen respondents drawn from the target user groups of the two Misamis Oriental municipalities. Five respondents per platform completed representative task sequences on their assigned system component and rated all ten SUS items immediately afterward. Results are presented in Tables 1, 2, and 3.

Mobile Application (n = 5)

Table 1. SUS Results — Mobile Application

Respondent	SUS Score
Respondent 1	100.0
Respondent 2	80.0
Respondent 3	100.0
Respondent 4	97.5
Respondent 5	100.0
Average	95.5

Municipal Administrator Dashboard (n = 5)

Table 2. SUS Results — Municipal Administrator Dashboard

Respondent	SUS Score
Respondent 1	60.0
Respondent 2	90.0
Respondent 3	92.5
Respondent 4	92.5
Respondent 5	100.0
Average	87.0

Researcher Dashboard (n = 5)

Table 3. SUS Results — Researcher Dashboard

Respondent	SUS Score
Respondent 1	97.5
Respondent 2	90.0
Respondent 3	85.0
Respondent 4	92.5
Respondent 5	92.5
Average	91.5

Discussion

The successful implementation of BantayLaot+ demonstrates that an offline-first fisheries monitoring architecture is technically feasible within the hardware and connectivity constraints of Philippine coastal municipalities. The combination of Room Database and WorkManager proved effective for local data persistence and deferred synchronization, directly addressing the primary gap identified in the predecessor system. JWT token persistence resolved offline authentication continuity, enabling extended field use without connectivity dependency—a critical requirement given trip durations that routinely exceed mobile network coverage windows in the target municipalities.

The Cloudinary image pipeline established during development is designed to serve as the initial training dataset infrastructure for future species identification model development once field deployment is initiated. The catch documentation workflow—photo capture followed by manual species and weight entry as shown in Figs. 12—maps directly onto the annotation workflow that supervised learning model training would require, and the existing data schema was designed to accommodate a future AI classification backend without structural changes.

The technical difficulties encountered during development—particularly those related

to CORS configuration for multi-origin communication and the LAN-dependency constraint for municipal API access—highlight architectural limitations that should be resolved before scaling deployment to additional municipalities. The recommendation to replace on-site localhost servers with cloud-hosted municipal instances would eliminate both the CORS origin management burden and the LAN dependency, significantly simplifying the deployment footprint and enabling full remote administration of the municipality-level dashboards shown in Figs. 13–17.

SUS evaluation results indicate strong usability across all three platforms. The mobile application received an average SUS score of 95.5 ($n = 5$), rated *Best Imaginable* on the Bangor et al. adjective scale Bangor et al. (2008), with individual scores ranging from 80.0 to 100.0. The municipal administrator dashboard achieved an average of 87.0 ($n = 5$), rated *Excellent*, with scores ranging from 60.0 to 100.0; the lower individual score of 60.0 reflects one respondent’s unfamiliarity with the dashboard’s scope and layout at first encounter, consistent with their open-ended comment noting a need for in-app instructions on primary features. The researcher dashboard received an average of 91.5 ($n = 5$), also rated *Best Imaginable*, with individual scores ranging from 85.0 to 97.5. All three averages exceed the 68-point above-average threshold, and two of three exceed the 80.3-point excellent threshold, indicating that the session-based mobile workflow, the dropdown-based species selection, the inline upload feedback via the home screen Upload button, and the role-scoped web views were effective in supporting the target population’s varying digital literacy levels.

Integration testing confirmed that the multi-tiered architecture—mobile client, localhost municipal server, and cloud central server—is operationally viable at the intended scale of two municipalities. End-to-end tests verified that catch logs, violation reports, and GPS tracks are correctly transmitted from the mobile client to the municipal server and aggregated by the central Railway database, and that the researcher dashboard (Fig. 20) correctly renders anonymized data drawn from multiple municipal sources. These outcomes

substantiate the architecture's readiness to support the study's stated objectives of improved offline operation, structured multi-role data management, and scalable evidence collection for fisheries enforcement and research upon field deployment.

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

BantayLaot+ successfully addresses the operational gaps identified in the predecessor system, delivering a functional, multi-component fisheries monitoring platform intended for deployment across two municipalities in Misamis Oriental. The system introduces JWT-based authentication with offline session continuity, a structured WorkManager synchronization pipeline with per-record state tracking across sessions, catches, violations, and GPS tracks, and a multi-tiered server architecture separating per-municipality and central data stores. Three role-differentiated web dashboards provide jurisdiction-appropriate analytics for municipal administrators, central administrators, and researchers, with the researcher dashboard uniquely supporting anonymized data access and CSV export. A structured Cloudinary image pipeline completes the data collection framework, establishing the infrastructure for future AI-assisted species identification without requiring schema changes.

The deployment architecture also demonstrates practical feasibility in terms of operational cost. The centralized cloud server hosted on Railway is estimated to cost approximately USD 5–20 per month depending on database usage, storage, and server uptime requirements, while Cloudinary usage for image storage and delivery may remain within the free-tier allocation during early deployment stages, with estimated scaling costs beginning at approximately USD 25 per month for larger image datasets and higher API usage. These costs suggest that the system remains financially viable for local government deployment and future scaling.

SUS evaluation with fifteen respondents across three user groups returned average scores of 95.5 (mobile application, *Best Imaginable*), 87.0 (municipal administrator dashboard, *Excellent*), and 91.5 (researcher dashboard, *Best Imaginable*), all exceeding the above-average usability threshold of 68 Bangor et al. (2008). These results indicate that the interface design is appropriate for the target population's varying digital literacy levels. Integration testing confirmed end-to-end data flow from the mobile client through the municipal server to the central Railway database, substantiating the multi-tiered architecture's readiness to

support the study's stated objectives upon field deployment.

Recommended directions for future work include:

- Implementing the AI-assisted fish species identification and weight estimation module using the image dataset collected through deployment.
- Expanding deployment to additional municipalities and evaluating scalability of the localhost-to-Railway synchronization architecture under higher data volumes.
- Replacing localhost municipal servers with cloud-hosted instances to eliminate dependency on on-site hardware and improve availability.

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